

Boom! India's Economy Set to Surge Over 7% Next Year – A Record Leap!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India's GDP is projected to rise to 7.4% for the financial year 2025-26, up from 6.5% in 2024-25, according to the Centre's advance estimates released on Jan 7, 2026.

Detailed analysis:

A growth rate above 7% signals strong macro-economic momentum, crucial for UPSC and state-level exams when discussing fiscal policy, development indicators, and the government's developmental agenda.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/indias-gdp-expected-to-grow-at-7-4-in-2025-26-centres-advance-estimates-10467811#publisher=newsstand>

From US Prison to Indian Soil: Wanted Gangster Bishnoi's Dramatic Return!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The CBI, in coordination with the Ministry of External Affairs and Home Affairs, facilitated the return of fugitive Aman alias Lawrence Bishnoi from the United States to India.

Detailed analysis:

The case underscores international cooperation in combating organized crime, a recurring theme in Indian Polity and Governance sections of competitive exams, highlighting extradition protocols and inter-agency coordination.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/lawrence-bishnoi-gang-member-brought-to-india-after-deportation-from-us-10470189#publisher=newsstand>

Singer Saved! Supreme Court Shields Folk Artist from Arrest in Controversial Post Case!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Supreme Court on Jan 7, 2026 granted interim protection from arrest to folk singer Neha Singh Rathore in a case filed against her for a social-media post about the Pahalgam terror attack.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights the balance between freedom of expression and legal restrictions, a key discussion point for constitutional law and media-related questions in civil services examinations.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/supreme-court-neha-singh-rathore-pahalgam-attack-top-court-grants-protection-from-arrest-to-singer-over-pahalgam-attack-post-10463996#publisher=newsstand>

Water Disaster! Dozens Die in Indore as Toxic Tap Sparks Panic!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Deaths from contaminated drinking water in Indore rose, with unofficial counts suggesting 20 deaths, while the state government officially acknowledged only four.

Detailed analysis:

Public health crises and governance response are vital topics for the Health and Governance modules of national exams, illustrating challenges in disaster management and data transparency.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/wont-get-into-numbers-chief-minister-amid-confusion-over-indore-deaths-10471793#publisher=newsstand>

Siddaramaiah Vows to Stay in Power Till He Gets the People's Nod – Karnataka's Veteran Leader!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Karnataka Chief Minister Siddaramaiah, now the longest-serving CM of the state, stated he will continue in politics as long as he enjoys the people's blessings.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding the political longevity of regional leaders aids in answering questions on state politics, leadership dynamics, and party structures in UPSC and state PSC exams.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/karnataka-news/will-remain-in-politics-until-i-have-peoples-blessings-karnataka-chief-minister-siddaramaiah-10470319#publisher=newsstand>

BJP Pays Tribute to Late Vilasrao Deshmukh – A Rare Cross-Party Nod!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said the BJP respects the late former CM Vilasrao Deshmukh for his role in shaping the state, despite political differences.

Detailed analysis:

The statement reflects inter-party respect and the role of individual legacies in Indian politics, relevant for questions on party dynamics, regional leadership, and political culture.

Source: <https://www.ndtv.com/india-news/bjp-respects-former-late-cm-vilasrao-deshmukhs-contribution-to-maharashtra-chief-minister-devendra-fadnavis-10470086#publisher=newsstand>

UN Declares Israel's West Bank Policies as 'Apartheid' – Global Outcry!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

In a new report, slammed by Israel, the U.N. rights office said "systematic discrimination" against Palestinians across the occupied Palestinian territories had "drastically deteriorated" in recent years.

Detailed analysis:

The UN's labeling raises diplomatic pressure on Israel and may fuel debates in international forums like the UNGA and ICJ. Aspirants should note the legal implications of the term 'apartheid', potential sanctions, and how this influences India's stance in the Middle East.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/un-accuses-israel-of-west-bank-apartheid/article70482396.ece>

Iran Hangs Mossad Spy – Cryptocurrencies, Espionage, and a Deadly Message!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The official IRNA news agency identified the man as Ali Ardestani, saying he relayed sensitive information to Mossad officers in return for financial rewards in the form of cryptocurrencies.

Detailed analysis:

The execution underscores Iran's hardening posture against Israel and highlights the growing role of crypto in espionage. Examine how this may affect Iran-Israel proxy conflicts and India's diplomatic balancing act in the region.

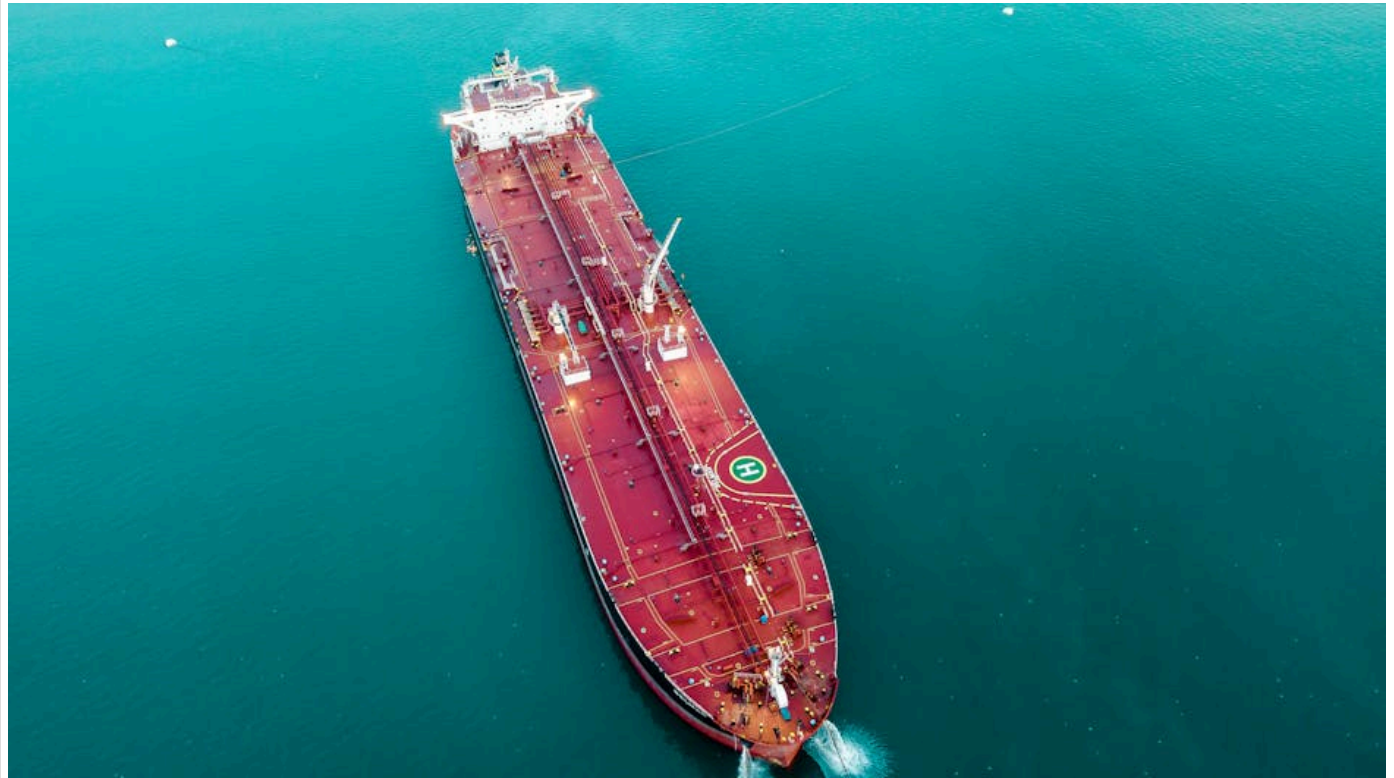
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/iran-executes-a-man-convicted-of-spying-for-israels-mossad/article70481700.ece>

U.S. Navy Nabs Russian Oil Tanker Near Venezuela – New Cold-War Flashpoint!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The seizure of the ship, which evaded being boarded near Venezuela, was a joint operation between the Department of Homeland Security and U.S. military personnel, the U.S. European Command, which is responsible for the region, said in a post on X.

Detailed analysis:

The incident signals escalating maritime tension between the U.S. and Russia, with implications for global energy markets and NATO's Atlantic strategy. Candidates should assess how this could impact India's oil imports and its strategic alignment.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/russia-sends-submarine-to-escort-tanker-the-us-tried-to-seize-off-venezuela-reports/article70482033.ece>

Norway Shatters Climate Records – 2025 Becomes the Hottest Year Ever!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Norway's national temperatures were 1.5°C higher than usual last year compared to the average during the period 1991-2020, and 2.8°C above the average during the pre-industrial era (1871-1900), according to the Norwegian Meteorological Institute.

Detailed analysis:

The data adds to global warming evidence, influencing climate negotiations at COP. Indian aspirants should note how such extremes affect Arctic geopolitics, sea-level rise concerns, and India's climate commitments.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/heatwave-mild-winter-make-2025-norways-hottest-year-ever/article70482047.ece>

China's 'Justice Mission 2025' Aims to Crush Taiwan's International Backing!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

China fired dozens of rockets towards Taiwan and deployed a large number of warships and aircraft near the island as part of its exercises, called "Justice Mission 2025".

Detailed analysis:

The drills heighten cross-strait tensions and test the resolve of U.S. allies. Examine potential repercussions for regional security, the Quad, and India's own maritime strategy in the Indo-Pacific.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/taiwan-says-chinas-war-games-sought-to-undermine-global-support-for-the-island/article70481972.ece>

Kosovo Underwater! Massive Floods and Power Outages Ravage the Balkans!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Severe flooding has hit Kosovo after days of heavy rain, leaving roads submerged, homes flooded, and power outages reported across several regions. Drone footage from the town of Kuzmin shows cars underwater and neighbourhoods inundated following intense rainfall over the past 24 hours. Authorities say emergency services are on high alert as weather forecasts warn of more rain in the coming days.

Detailed analysis:

The disaster highlights climate-induced hazards in Europe and tests EU emergency response mechanisms. For exam preparation, focus on international aid protocols, EU solidarity, and how such events influence migration and regional stability.

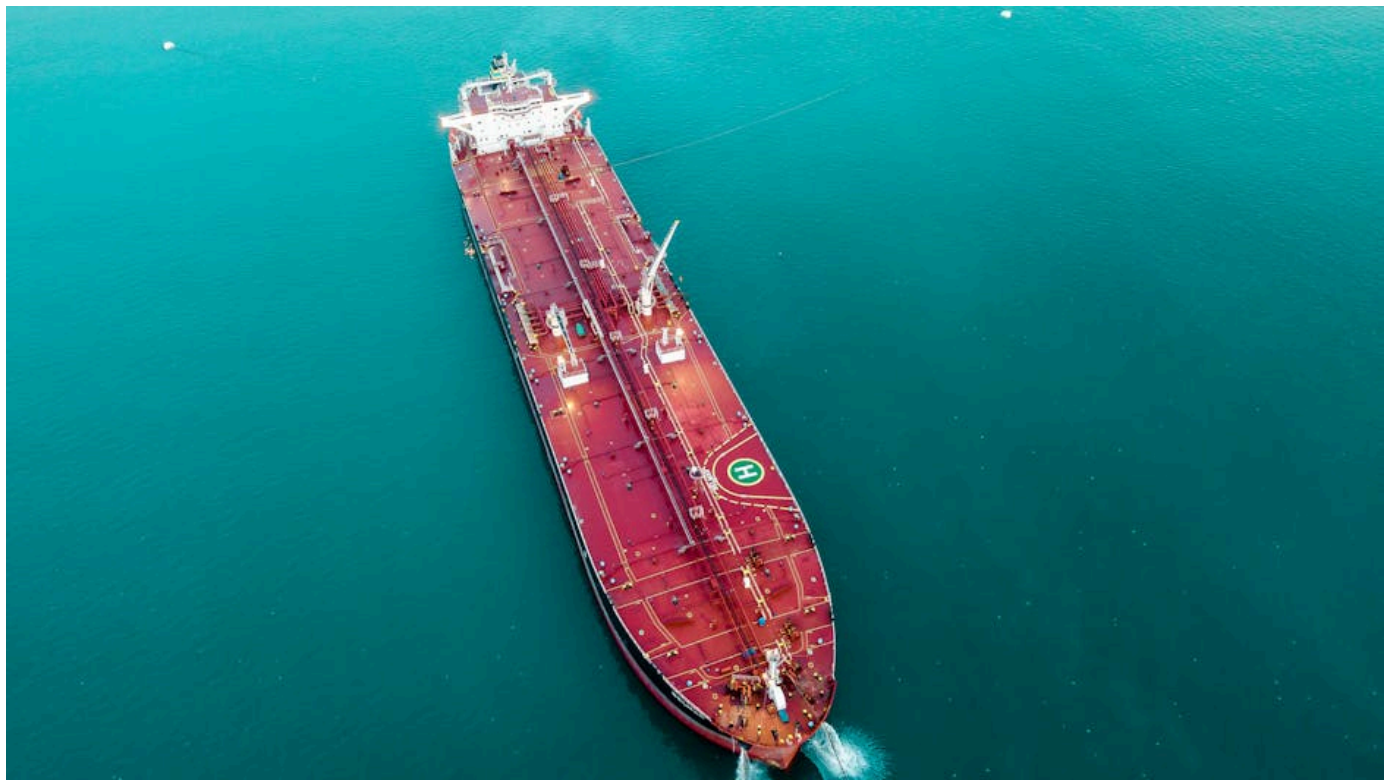
Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/videos/kosovo-battles-floods-and-blackouts-as-heavy-rains-lash-country/article70483363.ece>

US Navy Snags Secret 'Dark Fleet' Tanker in Daring Open-Sea Raid!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The US has seized the sanctioned vessel M/T Sophia in international waters and is escorting it to the US. The military coordinated with Homeland Security to apprehend the tanker, which is allegedly involved in illicit activities.

Detailed analysis:

The seizure underscores the US commitment to enforcing sanctions on clandestine oil shipments, signalling heightened risk for entities dealing in black-market oil. Exam candidates should note how such actions can disrupt global oil supply chains and affect commodity price volatility.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/us-military-seizes-stateless-sanctioned-dark-fleet-tanker-sophia-in-international-waters-video-11767797082431.html>

U.S. Blocks Russian-Flagged Oil Juggernaut Linked to Venezuela in Epic Atlantic Chase!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

This attempt to seize the vessel is part of the US' effort to create a 'blockade' of oil exports from Venezuela, as per two officials the news agency spoke to.

Detailed analysis:

By intercepting a Russian-flagged tanker tied to Venezuelan oil, the US aims to choke revenue streams that fund the Maduro regime. Understanding this move helps candidates grasp how geopolitical pressure points are used to influence energy markets and foreign policy.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/us-news/us-seizes-russian-flagged-oil-tanker-linked-to-venezuela-after-weeks-long-atlantic-pursuit-11767796269610.html>

India's New Highway Panel to Crush ₹5 Cr Disputes Before They Freeze Roads!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The pre-conciliation committee, set up by the ministry of road transport and highways, will attempt to resolve disputes valued under ₹5 crore between highway contractors and government authorities before they snowball into prolonged legal battles.

Detailed analysis:

The panel aims to speed up infrastructure delivery by preventing low-value litigations that delay projects. For aspirants, this illustrates government mechanisms to mitigate project risk and ensure timely completion of capital-intensive road works.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/govt-targets-small-disputes-choking-highways-with-new-resolution-panel-11767780360537.html>

India's 2027 Digital Census Set to Redraw Economic Maps with Self-Enumeration!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The housing listing for Census 2027 will take place from April to September 2026, including a self-enumeration option. This Census marks India's first digital enumeration.

Detailed analysis:

A fully digital census will generate real-time demographic and socioeconomic data, crucial for policy formulation, market sizing, and allocation of government funds. Candidates should appreciate how such data drives fiscal planning and private-sector strategies.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/india/census-2027-first-phase-to-take-place-between-april-september-self-enumeration-option-to-be-available-11767795159267.html>

Trump's Oil Ultimatum: Venezuela Must Dump China, Russia, Iran for U.S. Partnership!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

President Trump's administration is pushing Venezuela's interim leader to partner with the US on oil production while reducing ties with China, Russia, Iran, and Cuba.

Detailed analysis:

The advisory reflects a strategic push to realign Venezuela's oil sector under US influence, potentially reshaping global oil supply dynamics. Understanding such diplomatic pressure helps candidates evaluate risks in energy trade and sanctions regimes.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/world/trump-admins-fresh-warning-to-venezuela-cut-ties-with-china-russia-and-iran-partner-only-with-us-for-oil-production-11767775942700.html>

Pakistan Eyes Bangladesh Jet Deal – JF-17 Thunder to Boost South Asian Arms Trade!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Pakistan and Bangladesh air force chiefs discussed a potential defence pact that includes the sale of JF-17 Thunder jets.

Detailed analysis:

A defence pact would open a new export market for Pakistan's aerospace industry, enhancing regional arms trade and strategic ties. Aspirants should note how defence contracts affect balance of payments and geopolitical alignments in South Asia.

Source: <https://www.livemint.com/news/world/pakistan-defence-pact-with-bangladesh-sale-of-jf-17-thunder-jets-india-may-conflict-dhaka-new-delhi-islamabad-11767770799612.html>

— SPORTS —

*Messi's Shocking Confession: 'I'm Weirder Than Sh*t' – The Secret Life of Football's Biggest Star!*

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Lionel Messi opened up about his life off the pitch, sharing an honest reflection on his need for personal space.

Detailed analysis:

Messi's candidness underscores the mental health challenges elite athletes face; understanding such pressures helps aspirants appreciate the importance of psychological resilience in sports careers.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/im-weirder-than-s-t-lionel-messi-reveals-his-private-off-pitch-personality-says-he-enjoys-being-alone-101767766267446.html>

Olympic Flame Touches Down in Italy – The Countdown to 2026 Starts with a Fiery Spectacle!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

OLYMPICS-2026/RELAY (TV):Olympics-Flame reaches Italian city of Bologna a month before the Games begin.

Detailed analysis:

The flame's arrival signals final preparations for the 2026 Winter Olympics, highlighting logistics, international cooperation, and the economic boost for host cities—key topics for sports administration exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/others/olympicsflame-reaches-italian-city-of-bologna-a-month-before-the-games-begin-101767734055149.html>

Boulbina's Miracle Goal Sends Algeria to AFCON Quarter-Finals – Drama in the Final Minutes!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Algeria reaches Africa Cup quarterfinals on Boulbina's last-gasp winner, Ivory Coast also advances.

Detailed analysis:

AFCON progress reflects strategic gameplay under pressure; studying such clutch moments helps candidates analyze match tactics and tournament structures used in Indian sports coaching curricula.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/others/algeria-reaches-africa-cup-quarterfinals-on-boulbina-s-last-gasp-winner-ivory-coast-also-advances-101767735033459.html>

ISL Returns! February 14 Marks the Grand Comeback of India's Premier Football League!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The development ends months of uncertainty that followed a protracted legal battle due to the absence of a commercial partner for ISL.

Detailed analysis:

The ISL's revival illustrates the impact of commercial partnerships and legal frameworks on Indian sports leagues—critical knowledge for sports management and policy exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/football/isl-to-resume-from-feb-14-101767723664318.html>

Scheffler's Quest for a Career Slam & Koepka's Club-Hopping – Golf's Biggest Stories of 2026!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Scheffler's bid for career slam and Koepka's search for new home among golf topics for 2026.

Detailed analysis:

Tracking elite golfers' career goals offers insight into long-term athlete development and the business side of professional tours—relevant for sports economics and career planning modules.

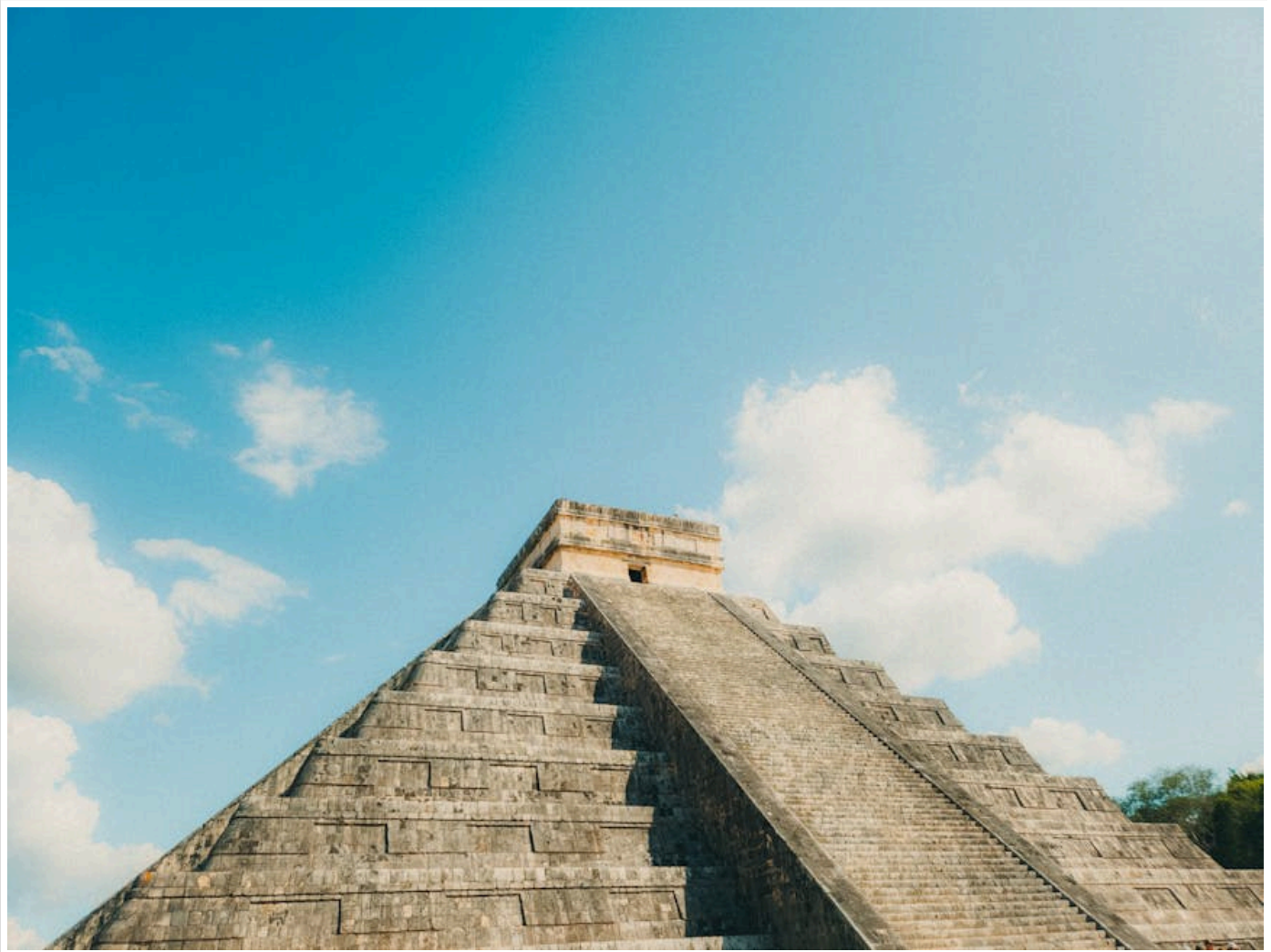
Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/others/schefflers-bid-for-career-slam-and-koepka-s-search-for-new-home-among-golf-topics-for-2026-101767735341818.html>

Teen Tennis Sensation Maaya's Mantra: 'Play More, Grow Stronger' – A Rising Star Targets the Australian Open!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

16-year-old Maaya Rajeshwaran Revathi is gearing up for the Australian Open juniors after a busy season, aiming to gain more pro experience and improve.

Detailed analysis:

Maaya's early professional exposure underscores the importance of junior pathways and talent identification—key concepts for sports science and coaching exam syllabi.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/sports/tennis/play-more-grow-stronger-teen-maaya-s-mantra-for-the-pro-grind-101767796780054.html>

India's Space Rocket Blasts Off in 2026 – A New Era for Defence Satellites!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The primary payload of the mission is the EOS-N1, an imaging satellite built for strategic purposes by the DRDO.

Detailed analysis:

Key for UPSC and SSC: showcases India's indigenous launch capability, DRDO-ISRO collaboration, and strategic satellite applications – a frequent topic in defence and science sections.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/isro-to-kick-off-2026-with-pslv-c62-launch-on-january-12/article70481555.ece>

Diamond Defects Unlock Super-Radiant Masers – Quantum Leap for Sensors!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Nitrogen-vacancy centres in diamonds can keep quantum spins coherent at room temperature, enabling ultrasmall sensors; packing trillions of these centres creates a superradiant maser.

Detailed analysis:

Important for physics and technology questions – illustrates quantum spin coherence, room-temperature quantum devices, and emerging sensor tech relevant to future R&D policies.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/nitrogen-vacancy-centres-diamond-quantum-spins-superradiant-maser/article70472909.ece>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

State-backed initiatives like the Thousand Talents Plan offer fast-tracked hiring and generous grants to lure overseas experts in strategically important fields.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights China's science diplomacy, talent acquisition policies and geopolitical implications – a recurring theme in international relations and science policy questions.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/overseas-scholars-drawn-to-chinas-scientific-clout-funding/article70481642.ece>

Lab Gets Real-World Pressure: Breakthrough X-Ray Surface Imaging!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

A novel XPS technique uses a de Laval nozzle to simulate atmospheric pressure, allowing catalysts to be examined under realistic conditions.

Detailed analysis:

Relevant for chemistry and material science – introduces advanced analytical methods that may feature in questions on industrial research and environmental tech.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/pressure-gap-x-ray-photoelectron-spectroscopy-de-laval-nozzle/article70477084.ece>

Grasslands: The Unsung Heroes of Global Climate Strategy!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Protecting grasslands requires coordinated goals across UN bodies; debates persist on aligning biodiversity and climate objectives and building institutional synergies.

Detailed analysis:

Important for environment and policy sections – emphasizes ecosystem diversity, UNFCCC negotiations, and the need for integrated climate-biodiversity strategies.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/grasslands-belong-national-global-climate-action-unfccc/article70477046.ece>

Ancient Calendar Mystery Solved – Time-Travel Through Science!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Detailed analysis:

While brief, the quiz touches on historical astronomy and ancient time-keeping—useful for general awareness and optional quiz sections in exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/science/science-quiz-a-millennia-old-calendar-system/article70473840.ece>

— HEALTH —

India's Health Lifeline on the Chopping Block!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

India's public health system struggles with chronic underfunding, privatisation, policy failure, and social inequities; doctors occupy a unique position of trust and moral authority, giving them the power to act as agents of social change and challenge policies that worsen disease and suffering

Detailed analysis:

Highlights systemic challenges and policy gaps that are core topics for UPSC and state health administration exams; understanding these issues helps candidates discuss health governance and reform proposals.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/privatisation-and-policy-gaps-threaten-indias-public-health-system/article70478257.ece>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

While observing that the reply given by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) was appropriate, the Commission said the affidavit was necessary to place the department's claim of non-availability of information on record before disposing of the appeal.

Detailed analysis:

Illustrates legal and transparency aspects of health financing, a frequent UPSC GS question on public health funding and the role of oversight bodies like the CIC.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/covid-vaccine-funding-data-not-available-cic-directs-dpiit-to-file-affidavit/article70482283.ece>

Sleep-Powered AI Can Forecast Your Future Illnesses!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The AI system was used to predict the future onset of disease by analysing sleep data, with health record data sourced from a sleep clinic

Detailed analysis:

Shows integration of AI in preventive healthcare—a hot topic for tech-policy sections of exams and for questions on emerging health technologies.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/researchers-develop-ai-model-that-predicts-disease-risk-from-sleep-data/article70481567.ece>

Mouse Genes Reveal Hidden Threat to Baby Brains!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The researchers also discovered notable sex-specific responses in the foetus, such as a vulnerability for a specific immune pathway in the male brain, that could be a potential target for early intervention

Detailed analysis:

Provides insight into developmental biology and sex-specific health policy, useful for genetics and public health questions in competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/genetic-study-in-mice-maps-pathway-linked-to-neurodevelopmental-defects-in-offspring/article70481371.ece>

B12 Deficiency: Silent Saboteur of Health!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

While Vitamin B12 deficiency is commonly attributed to dietary gaps, experts caution that the issue is more complex, with impaired absorption also playing a role; early diagnosis is crucial to ensure no long-lasting health effects

Detailed analysis:

Relevant for nutrition modules and clinical health sections; underscores the need to understand micronutrient absorption mechanisms for medical and public health exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/vitamin-b12-deficiency-is-more-than-just-a-nutrition-problem-experts/article70478223.ece>

Body Clock Slip May Accelerate Dementia!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Detailed analysis:

Connects chronobiology with neurodegenerative risk, a cutting-edge area that can appear in essay questions on ageing and preventive health strategies in civil services exams.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/study-links-weaker-internal-body-clock-with-higher-dementia-risk/article70477795.ece>

— EDUCATION —

GATE Admit Card Mystery Solved: Official Confirms Release Today!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Originally, the admit card was scheduled to be out on January 2, but it has been delayed.

Detailed analysis:

Critical update for GATE 2026 candidates; ensures they can download the hall ticket and plan exam logistics without missing the deadline.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/competitive-exams/gate-2026-admit-card-releasing-today-here-s-what-an-official-said-101767787009703.html>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

While the basic tenets of subjects will not change, the strategies, tools, and resources that are available to candidates have been reshaped by AI.

Detailed analysis:

Highlights how AI tools are reshaping study strategies, vital for JEE aspirants to stay competitive and leverage new technology.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/features/preparing-for-jee-main-in-the-age-of-ai-what-has-truly-changed-for-aspirants-101767774435711.html>

GUJCET 2026 Deadline Extended Again: Register Before Jan 16 or Miss Out!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

GUJCET 2026 registration date has again been extended. The last date to apply is till January 16, 2026.

Detailed analysis:

The extended deadline gives Gujarat engineering hopefuls extra time to complete registration, reducing last-minute pressure and increasing participation.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/competitive-exams/gujcet-2026-registration-date-again-extended-apply-till-january-16-at-gseborg-101767771530305.html>

CBSE Launches Groundbreaking Psycho-Social Support for Stressed Students!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

This initiative is aimed at addressing examination-related stress and emotional well-being, enabling students to approach their forthcoming Theory Exams.

Detailed analysis:

A timely move to help students manage exam anxiety, enhancing mental health and potentially improving performance in board and competitive exams.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/news/cbse-launches-psycho-social-counseling-support-for-students-from-january-6-101767757284903.html>

Test Your UPSC IQ: Daily Current Affairs Quiz Challenges Aspirants!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

See where you stand on current events with this short, no-pressure quiz. Scroll for answers at the end of the page

Detailed analysis:

Provides a quick self-assessment tool for civil services candidates, helping them gauge readiness on the vital current-affairs segment.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/upsc-daily-current-affairs-quiz-trump-venezuela-delhi-mosque-tariffs-t20-world-cup-bangladesh-icc-bcci-ipl-101767753364958.html>

NVS Class 9 LEST Admit Card 2026 Now Available – Download Instantly!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

NVS Class 9 LEST Admit Card 2026 has been released. The download link is given here.

Detailed analysis:

Essential information for Navodaya students appearing for the Class 9 LEST exam; immediate access to the hall ticket enables proper exam preparation.

Source: <https://www.hindustantimes.com/education/competitive-exams/nvs-class-9-lest-admit-card-2026-released-at-navodaya-gov-in-download-link-here-101767775815799.html>

— ECONOMY —

SEBI Gives Mutual Fund Distributors a Lifeline – New Incentives Delayed Till March!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Markets regulator SEBI extended the deadline to March 1 for rolling out extra incentives aimed at mutual fund distributors who bring in new individual investors from B-30 cities and new women investors from any city.

Detailed analysis:

For exam takers, note that SEBI's move underscores the push for deeper financial inclusion and retail participation. The extended timeline may improve distributor outreach, potentially boosting AUM growth and influencing future policy questions on market regulation.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/mf/mf-news/sebi-extends-timeline-till-mar-1-to-implement-additional-incentives-structure-for-mf-distributors/articleshow/126394967.cms>

Anand Rathi Rockets 45% in Just 90 Days – The New Star of Indian Broking!

Image 1 (Real):



Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Anand Rathi's shares jumped 45% over three months after its IPO on September 30, 2025, where it raised roughly Rs 746 crore, fueling strong early momentum.

Detailed analysis:

The surge highlights investor appetite for brokerage firms post-IPO and reflects broader market confidence in fintech-driven brokerage models—a topic often asked in UPSC economics papers on capital markets and private sector participation.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/stocks/news/broking-stocks-soar-anand-rathi-share-stock-brokers-leads-with-45-gain-in-3-months/articleshow/126390734.cms>

Coal Giant's IPO Set to Blast Off – 50% Premium Expected!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

The Bharat Coking Coal IPO, a book-built issue worth Rs 1,071.11 crore, opens on Jan 9. It involves a sale of 46.57 crore shares by Coal India Limited, with no fresh capital raised.

Detailed analysis:

Understanding the nature of a secondary-sale IPO is vital for exams. The high GMP indicates strong investor confidence in the coal sector, while proceeds to the seller illustrate government divestment strategy—relevant for questions on fiscal reforms and asset monetisation.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/ipos/fpos/bharat-coking-coal-ipo-kicks-off-on-jan-9-gmp-signals-strong-debut-with-50-premium-here-are-key-details/articleshow/126387770.cms>

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Ray Dalio argues that currency fluctuations, a surge in gold and worldwide capital reallocation defined 2025 markets more than US equity rallies, warning of low future returns and rising debt risks.

Detailed analysis:

Dalio's macro view ties directly to Indian monetary policy challenges—currency volatility, inflationary pressures, and debt sustainability. Aspirants should connect these insights to potential RBI actions and fiscal prudence questions in the economics syllabus.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/us-stocks/news/gold-currency-moves-and-global-rebalancing-shaped-markets-in-2025-ray-dalio/articleshow/126386534.cms>

Reliance Bounces Back! Jefferies Ups Target as Jio IPO Looms – 21% Upside Predicted

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

After a 4.4% dip wiping out Rs 94,000 crore in market value, Jefferies raised its 12-month price target for Reliance Industries to Rs 1,830, citing a potential Jio tariff hike and an upcoming Jio IPO as catalysts.

Detailed analysis:

RIL's dynamics illustrate the impact of telecom policy and corporate restructuring on stock valuations. This case is pertinent for questions on sectoral reforms, foreign investment, and the role of large conglomerates in India's growth story.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/markets/stocks/news/jefferies-lifts-ril-target-after-rs-1-lakh-crore-fall-pins-next-leg-of-rally-on-jio-ipo-tariff-hikes/articleshow/126386618.cms>

These 5 Mutual Funds Beat the Market by a Mile – See the Winners!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Five equity mutual fund schemes delivered strong outperformance over three years, led by Bandhan Small-Cap Fund, with high capture ratios indicating superior returns during bullish phases, per ACE MF data.

Detailed analysis:

Performance metrics like capture ratio and benchmark outperformance are key concepts for UPSC and state-level banking exams. Knowing top-performing funds helps answer questions on investment strategies, portfolio diversification, and the role of mutual funds in wealth creation.

Source: <https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/mf/analysis/top-5-equity-mutual-funds-that-outperformed-their-benchmarks-in-3-years/slideshow/126390394.cms>

Turtle SOS! Chennai's New Marine Elite Force Battles Deadly Trawl Nets to Rescue Thousands of Olive Ridleys

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Every year between December and April, the waters off Chennai turn into a nesting ground for Olive Ridley sea turtles. Since early December, an unusually high number of Olive Ridley turtles have been found dead along the coast. Trawl nets operating too close to shore trap turtles as they surface to breathe, pulling them underwater until they drown. In Chennai, a newly formed Marine Elite Force has been deployed to patrol coastal waters and intercept trawlers entering restricted zones.

Detailed analysis:

The article highlights a critical conservation effort linking marine policy, coastal management, and species protection. For exam prep, note the role of state-level enforcement (Marine Elite Force) in implementing the Wildlife Protection Act and the importance of designated turtle nesting zones under

the Coastal Regulation Zone (CRZ) rules. Understanding human-induced mortality (trawl nets) helps answer questions on threats to marine biodiversity and mitigation strategies.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/videos/watch-saving-olive-ridley-turtles-on-patrol-with-chennais-marine-elite-force/article70482295.ece>

Biomaterials Revolution: India's Home-grown Materials Set to Slash Fossil Fuel Imports!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

How can indigenous biomaterials reduce dependence on fossil-based imports?

Detailed analysis:

Biomaterials are renewable, biodegradable substances derived from biological sources (e.g., algae, agricultural waste). The piece underscores their potential to replace petro-chemical plastics, supporting India's push for self-reliance under the 'Atmanirbhar' initiative and meeting climate commitments. Candidates should link biomaterials to circular economy, waste management, and the National Bioeconomy Mission.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/what-are-biomaterials-and-how-do-they-work-explained/article70477939.ece>

Grasslands Under Siege: UN Pushes India to Save the World's Hidden Carbon Sinks!

Image 1 (Real):

 Original Image

Image 2 (Pexels):



Summary:

Protecting a biome like grasslands can't happen in isolation but must come about through goals shared by the various U.N. bodies. Unfortunately, there are still debates ongoing about whether biodiversity and climate goals align and how institutions can build synergies.

Detailed analysis:

The article stresses that grasslands store significant carbon and support biodiversity, yet they receive less policy attention than forests. For exams, remember that India's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) now reference grassland restoration, and the UNFCCC's work on ecosystem-based mitigation ties into the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD). Knowing these cross-institutional linkages can aid answers on climate-biodiversity integration.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/grasslands-belong-national-global-climate-action-unfccc/article70477046.ece>
